NovaCart Support Playbook: Escalations & Quality Ops

Category: Other (Escalations & Ops) | **Document ID:** SOP-OPS-OT-06 | **Version:** 2026.4 | **Scope:** Tier 1-3 Support

Section 1: De-Escalation Frameworks & Conflict Psychology

1.1 Executive Mandate: This operational standard trains frontline representatives to manage high-friction customer interactions, de-escalate acute frustration, apply empathy-driven problem resolution, and protect NovaCart's public reputation.

1.2 The L.A.S.T. De-Escalation Methodology

- **L - Listen Actively:** Allow customer to vent frustration completely for at least 45 seconds without interruption. Never speak over or correct minor factual slips while the customer is expressing emotion.
- **A - Acknowledge & Validate:** Authenticate their emotional experience without prematurely admitting corporate legal liability. ('I completely understand why this unexpected delay disrupted your schedule, and I am stepping in to fix this.')
- **S - Solve Proactively:** Present concrete, actionable options rather than passive company policies. Always provide choices when feasible (e.g., 'I can dispatch a priority replacement right now, or process an instant wallet refund').
- **T - Thank & Follow Through:** Thank customer for bringing the breakdown to our attention. Own the ticket through resolution and ensure commitments are completed within stated timeframes.

1.3 Power Phrasing vs. Defensive Triggers

Forbidden Defensive Phrase	Recommended Power Phrase	Psychological Impact
'Calm down, sir/ma'am.'	'I hear how frustrating this is, and I am focused on resolving this for you.'	Defuses anger instead of invalidating customer emotions.
'That is against our company policy.'	'While our standard terms don't cover this, here is what I can do to help today.'	Pivots from corporate rigidity to helpful partnership.
'There is nothing I can do.'	'Let me explore what options are available with our logistics supervisor.'	Maintains hope and agency; prevents immediate escalation.

Section 2: Abuse Handling, Boundary Setting & Termination Policies

2.1 Protecting Agent Wellbeing: NovaCart enforces a zero-tolerance policy against persistent verbal hostility, discriminatory hate speech, personal slurs, threats of violence, or sexual harassment.

2.2 The 3-Strike Warning Architecture

- **Strike 1 (Gentle Redirection):** 'Mr./Ms. [Customer], I understand you are upset, and I genuinely want to assist you. However, I must respectfully ask that we keep our conversation professional so I can solve this for you.'
- **Strike 2 (Formal Final Warning):** 'Mr./Ms. [Customer], as mentioned, personal insults prevent me from assisting you. If this language continues, I will be required to conclude this interaction.'
- **Strike 3 (Immediate Disconnect / Transfer to Blacklist):** 'Since the language has continued, I am now ending this session. Your case details have been documented for review.' (CSR selects disconnect code: `UNAUTHORIZED_ABUSIVE_TERMINATION`).

2.3 Unacceptable Behavior Escalation Matrix

Severe Incident Type	Immediate Action	Evidence Required	Platform Sanction
Threat of Physical Violence	Immediate line drop; flag to Security.	Call recording / Chat transcript log.	Permanent account ban; referral to police.
Sexual Harassment	Zero-strike instant disconnect.	Full transcript screenshot & audio stamp.	Account suspended indefinitely.
Blackmail / Extortion Threat	Transfer directly to Legal Affairs.	Customer written message / recording.	Legal team issues formal warning letter.
Persistent Chronic Harasser	Channel restricted to email only.	History of 3+ abusive terminations.	Phone/Live Chat access disabled.

Section 3: Escalation Hierarchies, Executive Routing & Legal Threats

3.1 Tiered Operational Escalation: Complex cases exceeding frontline empowerment thresholds must transition through established escalation hierarchies with comprehensive handover documentation.

3.2 Escalation Tier Governance

- **Tier-1 Frontline Agents:** First contact resolution, tracking updates, standard returns, order cancellations, and appeasements up to $15.
- **Tier-2 Floor Supervisors:** Exception handling, carrier geofence misdelivery disputes, repeat product defects, restocking fee waivers, and appeasements up to $50.
- **Executive Escalations Unit (EEU):** Direct customer outreach regarding CEO/Executive Office complaints, social media viral escalations, and complex multi-vendor disputes.
- **Legal & Regulatory Team:** Formal attorney representation, consumer court summons, statutory arbitration filings, or media press inquiries.

3.3 Customer Demands for Supervisor Protocol

Customer Scenario	Frontline Responsibility	Handover SLA	Required Ticket Note Format
Supervisor Requested (1st time)	Attempt one de-escalation pivot; explain capabilities.	Warm transfer: < 3 min wait.	Document exact root cause & previous offers.
Persistent Supervisor Demand	Initiate warm conference transfer or callback task.	Callback committed within 2h.	Include Customer Sentiment Score & LTV.
Legal Threat / Attorney Named	Do not argue; provide NovaCart legal address.	Transfer to Legal within 1h.	Tag ticket with `LEGAL_THREAT_ACTIVE`.
Social Media / Influencer Threat	Notify Brand PR Liaison Desk.	Expedited review: < 30 min.	Record follower count and post URLs if known.

Section 4: CRM Telemetry, AI Tooling Navigation & Quality Assurance

4.1 Support Infrastructure Architecture: Overview of CRM consoles, generative AI assistance tools, and key performance metrics governing representative quality audits.

4.2 Working Alongside AI Customer Copilots

- **Draft Response Auditing:** AI-generated macro suggestions must always be reviewed by the CSR for factual tone, verified name accuracy, and specific order context before transmission.
- **Automated Case Summaries:** Utilize internal AI summarization to absorb multi-turn conversation context quickly before accepting a transferred ticket.
- **Sentiment Triggers:** Pay close attention to real-time AI sentiment alerts (e.g., Sentiment Score falling below 30%) as an early warning to soften tone or propose proactive solutions.

4.3 Quality Assurance (QA) Key Performance Indicators

QA Metric	Target Threshold	Measurement Methodology	Remediation for Failure
First Contact Resolution (FCR)	>= 78%	Ticket resolved without reopen in 72 hours.	Coaching on product knowledge & policy empowerment.
Customer Satisfaction (CSAT)	>= 88% Positive	Post-interaction 5-star customer survey.	Weekly review of 1-star & 2-star transcripts.
Average Handle Time (AHT)	Voice: < 360s; Chat: < 600s	Telephony switch / CRM session timers.	Macro shortcut training & system typing navigation.
Ticketing Tagging Accuracy	>= 98%	Random monthly audit of 50 closed cases.	Mandatory refresher on taxonomy categorization.